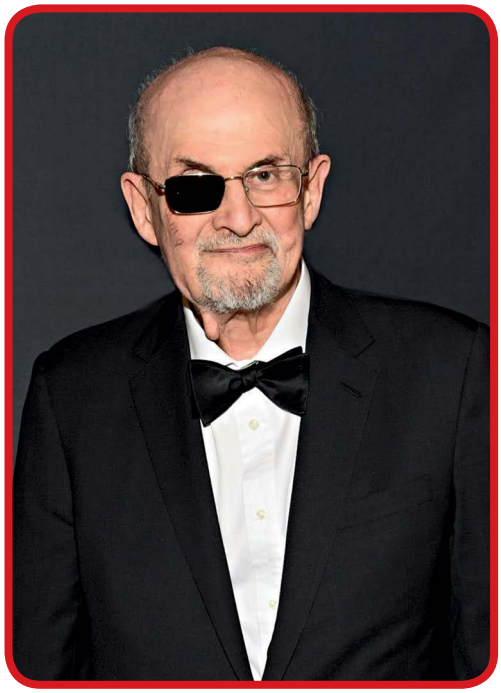
BOOKS TO LOOK FORWARD TO



KNIFE
By Salman Rushdie
Penguin Random House/ Non-fiction

This is a book that one wishes never had to be written. Rushdie's brave new memoir is a gripping account of surviving an attempt on his life 30 years after the fatwa was ordered against him. Speaking out for the first time and in unforgettable detail about the traumatic events of August 12, 2022, *KNIFE* is a powerful, deeply personal and ultimately uplifting meditation on life, loss, love, the power of art, finding the strength to keep going, and to stand up again. It releases on April 16, 2024.

THE GREAT FLAP OF 1942: How the British Raj Panicked Over a Japanese Non-Invasion
By Mukund Padmanabhan
Penguin Random House/ Non-fiction

'The Great Flap' was an expression used by British bureaucrats to describe the state of panic between December 1941 and mid-1942, when India mistakenly believed that Japan was going to invade its borders. The book takes in its arc the attack on Malaya, the conquest of Singapore, the bombing and eventual occupation of Burma, and the entry into the Indian Ocean.

HOLDING TIME CAPTIVE: A Biography of Ebrahim Alkazi
By Amal Allana
Penguin Random House/ Non-fiction

Alkazi, an Indian-born Saudi Arab, is invited by Nehru to set up the National School of Drama in post-Independence India. Set against the turbulence of World War II and Partition, and filled with personal insight, Allana's biography traces her father's journey towards the development of a modern idiom in Indian art in general, and theatre in particular.

SNAKES, DRUGS AND ROCK'N'ROLL
By Romulus Whitaker and Janaki Lenin
HarperCollins/Non-fiction

The story of a boy who would become one of the greatest conservationists of his generation. When his mother married and moved to Mumbai, Whitaker was transplanted from a conventional childhood in the US to what was for him the exciting world of India. At boarding school in Kodai, he kept a pet python under his bed. Sent to the US for college, Whitaker preferred snakes to lecture halls and left to work on a snake farm. Hair-raising and often hilarious, the first volume of his memoir brings the India of the 1950s and America of the 1960s to life.





UNDER THE INFLUENCE: How to Survive and Thrive Online
By Malini Aggarwal
HarperCollins/ Non-fiction

Malini Aggarwal, founder of the popular lifestyle blog Miss Malini, deep-dives into the psychology of online hate culture and provides practical tools to tackle it. She guides users on how to deal with cancel culture and combat negativity with positive action and mindfulness. An invaluable resource for anyone navigating the complex battlefield that is social media.

THE HACHETTE BOOK OF INDIAN DETECTIVE FICTION
Hatchette India/ Fiction

Following from the yellowback relaunch, curated by Hachette India MD Thomas Abraham, the imprint goes desi with an anthology of Indian detective fiction in two volumes. Includes 35 tales from the turn of the 19th century down to the present day.

THE HILL OF ENCHANTMENT: The Story of My Life as a Writer
By Ruskin Bond
Aleph/ Non-fiction

In May 2024, national treasure and grand old man of Landour, Ruskin Bond, will turn 90. To mark the occasion comes a new memoir (What! Another one!), full of stories he has never told before, his sources of inspiration, people he has loved, people he has lost, and a myriad other absorbing details about his long and successful life as a writer.

THE COBRA'S GAZE: Exploring India's Wild Heritage
By Stephen Alter
Aleph/ Non-fiction

In his latest book, Alter, the author of *Wild Himalaya*, *Becoming a Mountain* and *In the Jungles of the Night: A Novel about Jim Corbett*, travels extensively to explore India's jungles and the astonishing animals that live in them—from king cobras and snow leopards to tigers, elephants and dozens of others you may never even have heard of.

THE LAY OF THE LAND: A Story of India Through its Maps
By Deepti Anand and